Commas & Apostrophes

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. cat's
2. don't
3. hat, a scarf and gloves
4. A — Sam's bike (Sams' and Sams are wrong; a comma never replaces an apostrophe)
5. I'm
6. lions, tigers and bears
7. teacher's
8. she'll
9. A, D and E (the dog's, the cat's and the boy's all correctly show singular possession; B should be "dog's" for one dog, C should be "It's")
10. girl's
11. they're
12. eggs, milk and flour
13. dog's
14. can't
15. pens, pencils and rulers

Standard

16. boys' bags (boys is already plural, so the apostrophe goes after the s)
17. its
18. After the match, the players shook hands.
19. children's (an irregular plural - apostrophe before the s)
20. It's
21. Please pass the salt, Mum.
22. Yes - sisters is already plural, so the apostrophe goes after the s
23. Yes, I would love to come.
24. men's (an irregular plural)
25. cold, dark, windy night
26. A and C (James's correctly shows singular possession; the ladies' correctly shows plural possession; B misplaces the apostrophe, D should be plural "ladies'", E wrongly adds an apostrophe to "childrens")
27. Suddenly, the lights went out.
28. James's or James' (either is accepted)
29. No, I haven't finished yet.
30. ladies' (a plural possessive)

Standard / Hard

31. the cat's tail = belongs to one cat; the cats' tail = belongs to more than one cat
32. The two teams' captain shook hands.
33. My friend, who lives next door, is coming to tea.

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34. B) The children's book
35. The old house, which had stood for years, was finally sold.
36. It's a shame the puppy's toy broke.
37. Whose coat is this? It's very muddy.
38. A) Let's eat, Grandma!
39. A) Boss's office
40. whose = possessive (e.g. "Whose bag is this?"); who's = who is/has (e.g. "Who's coming?")
41. A, B and E (the dog's, the dogs' and the men's are all correctly punctuated for singular/plural possession; C wrongly adds an extra s, D should be "men's" since "men" is already plural)
42. Later that evening, we went outside.
43. witches' cauldron
44. A) It is a possessive pronoun, and possessive pronouns never take an apostrophe
45. mouse's

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. bird's
2. isn't
3. cats, dogs and rabbits
4. A — Emma's pencil case (Emmas' and Emmas are wrong; a comma never replaces an apostrophe)
5. we'll
6. bread, cheese and jam
7. baker's
8. didn't
9. A, D and E (the boy's, the horse's and the bird's all correctly show singular possession; B should be "boy's" for one boy, C should be "It's")
10. Emma's
11. you're
12. London, Paris and Rome
13. horse's
14. won't
15. toys, books and games

Standard

16. twins' toys
17. its
18. In the morning, the birds sing loudly.
19. people's
20. It's
21. Come here quickly, Dad.
22. Yes - girls is already plural, so the apostrophe goes after the s
23. Well, I suppose you could come.
24. women's
25. bright, warm, sunny afternoon
26. A, C and E (Chris's correctly shows singular possession; the knights' correctly shows plural possession for many knights; the men's is correct too; B misplaces the apostrophe, D should be plural "knights'")
27. Without warning, the alarm sounded.
28. Chris's or Chris'
29. No, I don't think that's fair.
30. knight's

Standard / Advanced

31. "the class's trip" — class is singular (one class), so the apostrophe goes before the s.
32. No — this is a plural decade, not a possessive, so no apostrophe is needed (1990s).
33. "my parents' car" — parents is plural (more than one owner), so the apostrophe goes after the s.
34. Yes — it goes before the s, as "the dog's bone," because one dog owns it.
35. "Yours" is already a possessive pronoun, so it never takes an apostrophe, e.g. "That book is yours."
36. My sister's best friend, whose name is Priya, is staying this weekend.

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37. The two dogs' bowls were empty and the cat's bowl was full.

38. Tom's coat, scarf and gloves were soaked.

39. B — the commas show that all the friends are visiting, and they happen to live abroad.

40. "It's the children's turn next," said the referee.

41. A, C and E (yours, it's and theirs are all correctly formed; B and D wrongly add apostrophes to possessive pronouns)

42. The sun's rays warmed the beach, and the children's laughter filled the air.

43. A) Because they are already possessive pronouns

44. C) witches' spell

45. B) The girl's bag was heavy, so she couldn't lift it.

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